

Business Case: Process Failure & Improvement Initiative

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Incorrect Carpet Supply – Luxury Hotel Project, USA • Brintons Carpets • 2010-2013

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01 Project Overview | BACKGROUND

Background

Brintons Carpets is a UK-headquartered premium carpet manufacturer supplying custom Axminster carpets to luxury hospitality clients globally. The India Service Centre provided design, planning & estimation, and project management services across all global regions including Americas, EMEA, and Asia Pacific.

A critical process failure occurred when an incorrect carpet design was manufactured and supplied for a large-scale luxury hotel corridor project in the USA. The error — originating at the design stage — was not caught at any subsequent checkpoint, resulting in the wrong product being delivered. This triggered urgent re-manufacturing, air freight from India to the USA, reinstallation, and significant reputational risk with a key hospitality client.

My Role

As the Process Improvement Leader and PACE (Profit & Cash Execution) Champion for the Service Centre, I was responsible for leading the root cause analysis, identifying process gaps, implementing corrective measures, and monitoring their effectiveness.

02 Root Cause Analysis | RCA

Stakeholder Interviews & Process Mapping

To understand the full breakdown, I conducted structured interviews with key stakeholders across the delivery chain:

- Senior & Junior Designers — to assess the design approval workflow
- Project Managers — to understand project timelines and approval processes
- Planning Team — to analyse how order specifications were documented
- Production Design & Design Support Teams — to evaluate QC and verification steps

Using end-to-end business process mapping, the full workflow was visualised and key failure points identified.

Primary Root Cause

The designer selected an incorrect pattern, colour, and dimension variant for production. This error was not caught at any subsequent checkpoint — passing through design review, client approval, manufacturing, and pre-shipment inspection without being flagged.

Diagnostic Matrix — Root Cause Breakdown

PROCESS	PEOPLE	SYSTEM
No independent secondary validation of design before production approval	Designer selected incorrect variant without peer check	No automated QC checkpoint to match product against approved spec
No process checkpoint to verify manufactured product against specification	Communication gaps between Design, Production, and Logistics	No pre-shipment verification against signed-off design
Process Change Authorisation absent — deviations went untracked	Escalation protocols not triggered at failure points	Missing traceability linking production batch to approved specification

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Impact Analysis

| CONSEQUENCES

Financial Impact

The financial impact was significant — encompassing re-manufacturing costs, urgent air freight from India to the USA, reinstallation labour costs, and project delays causing additional client-side costs.

Operational Impact

- Supply chain disruption — resources reallocated to meet urgent production demands
- Project timeline delays impacting hotel operations and contractor scheduling
- Increased pressure across Design, Production, and Logistics teams

Reputational Impact

- Client dissatisfaction — loss of confidence in quality assurance processes
- Risk to future contracts with a key luxury hospitality account
- Internal escalation requiring senior management involvement

04

Process Improvement Strategy

| CORRECTIVE MEASURES

Process Mapping & Standardisation

- Developed detailed process flowcharts covering design validation, approval, and production QC
- Implemented a Process Change Authorisation Procedure — requiring documentation and sign-off for any deviation from standard processes

Design Validation Enhancement

- Introduced mandatory two-level design validation before production
- Required peer review of all designs before client approval submission
- Implemented formal digital approval process ensuring client sign-off before production

Quality Control Strengthening

- Established QC checkpoints to verify manufactured carpets against approved designs
- Introduced pre-shipment verification procedures before dispatch
- Implemented material traceability — linking each production batch to its approved specification

Cross-Functional Communication & Training

- Conducted cross-departmental training on quality assurance and error prevention
- Introduced regular alignment meetings between Design, Production, and Logistics
- Developed a corrective action tracking system to monitor identified issues and implemented fixes

"Process failures in complex supply chains often stem from small overlooked errors — preventative controls at multiple checkpoints are critical."

05 Outcomes & Lessons Learned | RESULTS

ERROR RATE REDUCTION >50% Following structured QC checkpoints and process controls	QC CHECKPOINTS ADDED 3 Design validation, production QC & pre-shipment verification	PROCESS CONTROL PCAP Process Change Authorisation Procedure embedded as standard
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Immediate Outcomes

- Corrective replacement delivered to the client with expedited turnaround
- Process gaps formally documented and remediation plan implemented
- Senior management and client communication managed to preserve business relationship

Long-Term Improvements

- Error rates reduced by over 50% following implementation of structured QC checkpoints and process controls
- Process Change Authorisation Procedure embedded as standard practice across the Service Centre
- Improved cross-functional alignment between Design, Production, and Logistics

- Strengthened quality governance framework — reducing risk of recurrence on future high-value projects

Key Takeaways

- Structured RCA and stakeholder interviews surface the real root cause — not just the symptoms
- Cross-functional process mapping is essential for identifying where accountability and communication gaps exist
- Embedding quality controls and tracking mechanisms creates sustainable improvement — not just one-time fixes

06 Conclusion | CLOSING

This case study highlights the importance of robust quality control, cross-functional communication, and structured process validation in large-scale manufacturing and supply chain operations. By applying a disciplined BA and process improvement approach — from root cause analysis through to implementation and monitoring — the Service Centre significantly strengthened its quality governance and reduced the risk of recurrence on future high-value hospitality projects.